

MATTHEW GOURD

London · Senior Technical Writer · Information Engineer

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PROFILE

Technical writer and information engineer driving developer adoption in high-growth fintech and SaaS. More than 25 years of writing experience, including seven years in developer documentation and building Viva Wallet's developer portal from scratch. Deep expertise in API and SDK documentation, docs-as-code workflows, and AI-assisted authoring, with a focus on getting developers from first read to working integration as quickly as possible.

CORE SKILLS

Documentation expertise: API and SDK documentation, developer portals, information architecture

Docs-as-code stack: Markdown, AsciiDoc, MDX, Docusaurus, Hugo, Antora, Mintlify, Scalar

API standards: OpenAPI, Swagger, JSON, YAML

Tooling: Git, GitHub, GitLab, VS Code, Cursor, Copilot

AI-assisted authoring: Custom GPTs, MCP servers, agentic workflows, prompt design for doc review

Leadership: Distributed team management, mentoring, style guide adoption

EXPERIENCE

Senior Technical Writer · Backbase · Dec 2025 – Present

- Author technical documentation for solution engineers and developers delivering complex banking implementations.
- Standardise documentation workflows to improve consistency across distributed teams.
- Maintain an AI workflow to extract implementation details from source code and accelerate delivery without lowering quality.

Documentation Manager · Backbase · Jul 2023 – Nov 2025

- Led a distributed team of technical writers, improving collaboration, productivity, and team growth.
- Wrote developer guides with engineering and solution teams for complex banking software.
- Developed AI-assisted authoring workflows while maintaining rigorous quality standards and repeatable review practices.

Senior Technical Writer · Backbase · Nov 2021 – Jul 2023

- Created technical and integration documentation for global banking software.
- Implemented the Google Developer Documentation Style Guide across EMEA teams.
- Improved peer review processes and content strategy to enable faster, more reliable release cycles.

Technical Account Manager · Viva Wallet · May 2021 – Oct 2021

- Acted as the primary technical liaison for enterprise clients during high-stakes system incidents.
- Produced payment API guides and technical enablement content to support developer adoption.
- Built a fully automated docs-as-code pipeline using GitHub and Markdown.

Technical Writer · Viva Wallet · Jan 2019 – Apr 2021

- Launched the company's first scalable developer documentation platform by creating a developer portal from scratch with docs-as-code workflows.
- Produced API, SDK, and plugin documentation for a payment integration platform to help developers move from initial setup to successful implementation faster.
- Established documentation analytics and feedback loops to enable data-driven content optimisation.

Digital Content Officer · University of the Arts London · Apr 2018 – Dec 2018

- Led large-scale content migration during a CMS transition affecting more than 20,000 students.
- Redesigned online forms and workflows to better support a diverse student population.

Technical Writer · ipagoo · Sep 2017 – Feb 2018

- Produced Open Banking API documentation during a critical regulatory transition.
- Launched the company's first developer portal in a high-growth fintech startup environment.

Technical Writer (Contract) · MIRACL · Jun 2016 – May 2017

- Authored documentation for complex cryptographic SDKs and multi-factor authentication platforms.
- Conducted technical reviews and platform testing on AWS infrastructure for worldwide deployment.

Technical Writer (Contract) · Mumsnet · Mar 2016 – May 2016

- Created onboarding documentation for distributed Java, iOS, and Android teams.
- Designed infrastructure diagrams and process flows supporting remote engineering operations.

Web Manager · Chartered Institute of Public Relations · Aug 2012 – Mar 2016

- Managed content strategy for the corporate website serving PR professionals across multiple regions.
- Led digital campaigns, including national awards, by coordinating remote cross-departmental teams.

Earlier roles across enterprise software, telecoms, and professional services (including Fujitsu and BT) established the foundations in API and product documentation, content strategy, and editorial process that underpin current senior work.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Agentic AI for Developers: Concepts and Application for Enterprises** · LinkedIn Learning, 2025
- **Using Generative AI in Technical Writing** · Cherryleaf, 2025
- **People Manager Program** · Lepaya, 2024

EDUCATION

University of Wales, BSc (Hons) Technology Management (part-completed)

Marling Grammar School: 10 GCSEs, 2 A-Levels (English, Art)